



James Macmillan

Cover Letter

Hey, I'm James, a Senior Software Engineer based in the Midlands, and I appreciate you taking the time to check out my CV.

I'm currently seeking full-time remote opportunities as a Senior Developer. With over 10 years of commercial web development experience and more than 5 years building cross-platform mobile applications, I bring a deep and well-rounded skill set to any team.

Over the past two years, have built and operated multiple production applications across both AWS and GCP, gaining solid cross-cloud experience in real-world environments.

My preferred stack includes Node.js or .NET Core on the backend, paired with React and Tailwind on the frontend. That said, I've worked extensively across a broad range of frontend and server-side technologies, and I'm quick to adapt where needed.

I started building for the web at age 12, growing my skills alongside the evolution of the web itself — from desktop to mobile and beyond. Today, I specialise in full-stack development within the JavaScript ecosystem, but I also bring experience in a wide range of team environments, workflows, and technical architectures.

I'd be a strong addition to any dev team looking for a seasoned, pragmatic engineer with a passion for clean code, great UX, and effective collaboration.

Thanks again for your time,

James Macmillan



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Email

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Address

Midlands, UK.



Availability

1 Month



Seeking

Full time, remote roles in the UK.

This CV was written with ♥ in the Midlands, Using  Vite,  React,  Tailwind & others.

Experience

Profile

I'm a friendly and passionate Full Stack Developer with a strong background in Agile delivery, design, UX/UI, and application architecture. I love working across the full stack — from front-end and mobile apps to cloud-native serverless apis and data stores — and have a particular focus on building robust hybrid mobile and progressive web apps.

Over the years, I've worked closely with teams of all experience levels, helping to bring ideas to life and solve tricky business problems with practical, well-designed solutions. I'm at my best when I'm collaborating with others who love technology as much as I do, and when we're building something meaningful, together.

Songtradr

Mar '23 - Present



Ingesting the world's music one release at a time.

I joined the Media Delivery and Ingestion team, where I worked on building and maintaining large-scale, serverless applications that handled the ingestion, processing, and global distribution of music and its metadata. I contributed to re-platforming key parts of the output pipeline, including pricing logic and global availability handling, and helped implement a scalable document store to support responsive release ingestion.

The role gave me deep exposure to fast-paced, pragmatic development using XP practices and TDD. The team focused on using the right tool for the job, delivering robust, high-performance solutions while cutting unnecessary complexity and waste. We made it a priority to empower business users with fast, reliable access to the data they needed, supporting both internal goals and growing client demands.

Engineius

Jul '20 - Feb '23



Overhauling, updating, and improving Mobile and Web apps.

I was tasked with overhauling the Engineius mobile app, while transitioning its development in house. I significantly improved the performance, UX/UI, stability and maintainability of the app. I also worked to significantly improve the architecture and performance of the company's main web app.

I delivered multiple business derived projects working closely with the end users involved. I also lead and mentored new employees on the mobile app's development.

Packt

Nov '17 - Jan '20



Shipping the mobile app for the Subscription platform and going Serverless.

I worked with Packt for 2 years on the Subscription platform. I was initially hired to expand the web application into a cross platform mobile app. I was also instrumental in migrating the API to use the Serverless framework on AWS. I worked with a team of developers with varying skill sets, helping to upskill and train new members of the team.

My development career became very focussed on Javascript stacks, writing brilliant code to solve complex solutions on a variety of platforms. During my time with Packt I endeavoured to improve code quality across the stack, helping develop and implement the code style used in house.

Severn Trent

Sep '12 - Oct '17



Delivering web and mobile apps to drive the business forward.

Stacks

My favourite stack these days is Node.js running on Lambdas or containers, backed by a solid RDS and object storage setup. On the front end, I enjoy working with React (or similar component-based frameworks), styled with Tailwind and bundled up nicely. For mobile, I've been a long-time fan of Ionic but I'm open to exploring other frameworks like React Native or Flutter, depending on the project requirements.

That said, I've worked across a range of setups — from traditional stacks with Node and .NET Core APIs deployed on AWS (via containers, EC2s, and Lambdas), to static and server-side rendered sites. Recently I've enjoyed working on cloud-native applications in AWS and GCP, leveraging the power of serverless architectures and microservices to build scalable and efficient systems.

Interests

Outside of work, I'm a keen photographer and avid reader, and I've recently been getting really into 3D modelling. My interests shift and grow over time, but a few creative passions have stuck with me.

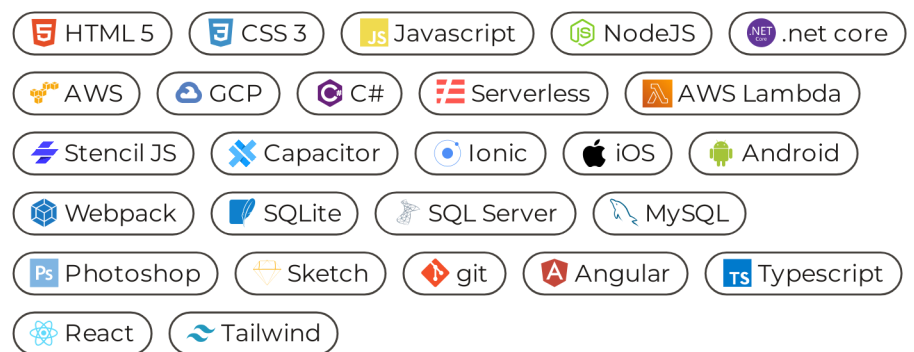
I enjoy learning new things to stretch my thinking and grow as a developer — over the past few years I've explored game programming, machine learning, and parametric modelling. Picking up new paradigms and ways of thinking helps me stay sharp and keeps my curiosity alive.

Skills

Here's a quick overview of the technologies and tools I've worked with over the years. If there's something specific you're curious about that's not listed, feel free to reach out — there's a good chance I've come across it.

Over the last decade, I've built up a broad range of experience in web and mobile development. That's included everything from UX/UI design and performance tuning to unit testing, CI/CD pipelines, software architecture, and working with various databases.

I've also had the chance to lead and mentor developers at all levels, and I've worked across a mix of teams and processes — though I'm happiest in a well-run Agile environment with good people and a clear purpose.



Education

Coventry University Jan '09 - Jan '12

BSc Computer Science *G400, 2.1 with Honors*

Caroline Chisholm School Jan '02 - Jan '09

3 A Levels *Including Computing*
11 GCSEs

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Projects

2021

Portal Architecture

Engineius

TS Typescript

.NET .net core

A Angular

Updated the Web Portal's architecture to split front end and api.

The customer facing web portal was serving via. an old Angular .net core template's architecture. Each client route returned an angular app as a page.

In this project I extracted the front end Angular apps into their own project, bootstrapped webpack and switched all routing to the angular front end. This involved overhauling routing, the webpack build, and the angular project as a whole.

As a part of this project I also identified that the vendor bundle had been misconfigured, serving node_module dependencies twice. Fixing this, implementing Lazy Loaded routing and separating the front end server from the back-end server resulted in significant performance improvements.

This also had a significant impact on development turnover, prior to these changes the rebuild cycle was well over a minute on most developer's machines.

2020

Mobile App

Engineius

Bringing a third party development in house

Engineius originally outsourced their app development as is common in early startup phase. This project involved bringing the functioning production app development in house and up to a long term maintainable standard.

My initial work here was to take stock, and roughly plan the necessary changes to ensure long term maintenance. There was also a looming deadline of an iOS upgrade deprecating the old Web View.

I started by implementing some node best practices; dependency pinning, auto formatting & linting with CI layer build checks. I then upgraded the underlying frameworks to their latest stable versions, this included bringing Nativescript to v7+ and Angular to 12+. As these were significant major version releases there was lots of in depth analysis and retest work along with the development.

Once this work was complete and functioning I then focused on outstanding production app issues. In particular there were multiple memory leaks, performance drags and the app's styling had not been completed or branded.